

Jacoby Two Notrump

A 2NT response to a Major suit opening promises at least 4-card support and at least opening hand strength. It is absolutely forcing to game.

Opener's second bid describes her hand further:

- 4 of the Major shows a minimum featureless hand

- 3NT shows extra strength and a 5-card trump suit

- 3 of the Major shows extra strength and a 6+ card trump suit

- 3 of any other suit shows shortness (singleton or void)

- 4 of any other suit shows a second 5-card suit

Splinter Bids

A double-jump-shift as a response to partner's opening 1 of a Major suit is a Splinter bid. It shows opening hand strength, at least four card support for the Major, and a singleton or void in the "splintered" suit. It is absolutely forcing to game.

BakerBridge has complete lessons for these conventions.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 6♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦5

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♣A

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣10

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦2

Board: 5

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: North

Lead: ♣4

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 9 6 4 3 2

♥ 4

♦ J 10 4 3

♣ 7 4

♠ A 5

♥ A J 10 9 6 2

♦ K Q 7

♣ 6 3



♠ J 8 7

♥ Q 3

♦ 8 6 5 2

♣ A J 8 5

♠ K Q

♥ K 8 7 5

♦ A 9

♣ K Q 10 9 2

NORTH's 3♥ rebid shows better than average strength and six trumps.

Just what SOUTH was hoping for. She bids Blackwood - her plan is to bid 7♥ if NORTH has three Aces, bid 6♥ if he has two Aces, and stop at 5♥ if he has just one. If North has no Aces SOUTH will get a new partner.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1♥	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♥	Pass	4NT
Pass	5♥	Pass	6♥
All Pass			
6♥ by North			
Lead: ♦ 5			

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 9 7 2

♥ A 9 5

♦ Q 5

♣ K Q 10

♠ 8

♥ 10 8 2

♦ 9 7 2

♣ 9 8 7 6 4 3



♠ A Q 10 6 4

♥ K Q J 7

♦ K J

♣ J 5

♠ 5 3

♥ 6 4 3

♦ A 10 8 6 4 3

♣ A 2

*West**North**East**South*

1 ♠

Pass

2NT

Pass

3NT

Pass

4 ♥

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♣ A

EAST indicates an above normal opening with five ♠s by her 3NT rebid.

WEST also has some extra strength so he makes a Control showing bid of 4 ♥.

Despite both partners showing extra strength East merely signs off at 4 ♠. Why? Because WEST's Control bid of 4 ♥ denied first-round control in both ♣s and ♦s. EAST realized she was off two Aces.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 2
♥ 9 6 3
♦ K 10 7 3 2
♣ 10 9 7

♠ A 7 6 3

♥ A Q 8 4

♦ 9 4

♣ K Q 2



♠ 10 4

♥ 10 5 2

♦ A J 6

♣ A J 6 5 3

♠ K Q J 8 5

♥ K J 7

♦ Q 8 5

♣ 8 4

SOUTH has a minimum opening hand with no extra features to brag about. So after NORTH's Jacoby 2NT bid he merely signs off at 4♠.

NORTH would have cooperated if SOUTH had made a slam try, but she doesn't have enough to initiate the investigation herself.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
			1♠
Pass	2NT	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by South			
Lead: ♣10			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ Q 8 4
♥ A K 8 4 2
♦ 4
♣ K J 9 5

♠ K 10 9

♥ 9 6

♦ J 8 2

♣ 10 8 6 3 2



♠ A 7 6 5
♥ Q J 10 7
♦ K Q 7 5
♣ 4

♠ J 3 2

♥ 5 3

♦ A 10 9 6 3

♣ A Q 7

EAST's 4♣ is a Splinter bid. He promises 13+ points, at least four ♥s and a singleton or void in ♣s.

WEST is obviously forced to game, but she is not thrilled to hear about EAST's ♣ shortness. In fact, it does nothing to help the value of her hand. So she bids the ♥ game.

West

1♥

4♥

All Pass

4♥ by West

Lead: ♦ 2

North

Pass

East

4♣

South

Pass

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 3
 ♥ A 10 8 4
 ♦ 5 4 3
 ♣ A 9 7 5

♠ A Q 9 8 6 4

♥ Q J 7

♦ J 2

♣ K Q



♠ 2

♥ 9 5 3 2

♦ A 10 7 6

♣ 10 6 4 2

♠ K J 7 5

♥ K 6

♦ K Q 9 8

♣ J 8 3

NORTH bids 3♠ to show the 6-card suit plus some extra strength.

SOUTH's failure to make a Control bid in either ♣s, ♦s or ♥s, means just one thing - She doesn't have any controls.

So NORTH settles for game.

<i>West</i>	<i>North</i>	<i>East</i>	<i>South</i>
	1♠	Pass	2NT
Pass	3♠	Pass	4♠
All Pass			
4♠ by North			
Lead: ♣4			